

Business Expense & Reimbursement Policy

Northwind Traders, Inc. | Finance Department | Effective: February 1, 2026 | Version 5.1 | Policy Owner: Corporate Controller

1. Purpose

This policy defines what business expenses Northwind Traders will reimburse, the approval process, and documentation requirements. It applies to all employees who incur expenses on the Company's behalf.

2. General Principles

- Expenses must be reasonable, necessary, and directly related to Company business.
- Employees should select the most cost-effective option available that meets the business need.
- The Company does not reimburse expenses for spouses, family members, or guests unless pre-approved for a specific business purpose.

3. Expense Categories & Limits

Category	Standard Limit	Approval Required Above Limit
Client meals	\$100/person	Director
Team meals / offsites	\$75/person	Manager
Ground transportation	Actual cost	N/A
Software / SaaS subscriptions	\$500/year	Department VP
Office supplies	\$150/month	Manager
Professional development	\$1,000/year	Manager
Client gifts	\$75/recipient	Director

4. Submission Process

All expenses must be submitted through the ExpensePath system within 30 calendar days of the purchase date. Reports submitted after 60 days require written justification and VP approval, and may be denied at the Company's discretion.

5. Receipt Requirements

An itemized receipt is required for any single expense of \$25 or more. Credit card statements alone are not sufficient documentation. For meals, the receipt must show the itemized order — not just the total — along with the business purpose and names of attendees.

6. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Traffic or parking fines, and other personal legal violations.

-
- Airline seat upgrades beyond the class permitted under the Travel Policy.
 - Personal entertainment, mini-bar charges, and in-flight movies.
 - Spa services, gym fees while traveling, and personal grooming.
 - Alcohol at value greater than \$30/person, unless pre-approved for a client event.

7. Approval Matrix

Expense Amount	Required Approver
Up to \$500	Direct Manager
\$500 – \$2,500	Department Director
\$2,500 – \$10,000	Department VP
Above \$10,000	VP + Finance Business Partner

8. Reimbursement Timeline

Approved expense reports are reimbursed via direct deposit within 7 business days of final approval, on the Company's standard bi-weekly payment cycle.

9. Contact

Questions: ap@northwindtraders.example or the #ask-finance Slack channel.